

THE FAR SITE HOUSE

MALLESHWARAM, BENGALURU, KARNATAKA

Plot Area: 2,400 sq ft

Built-up Area: 7,000 sq ft

Project Timeline: 2018 - 2020

Project Cost: INR 5,000 per sq ft



TECHNOARCHITECTURE, BENGALURU

Principal Architect: Rajesh Shivaram

Project Team: Rupali, Megha, Yashaswini

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“Architecture cannot be explained, it has to be experienced. Being a firm believer of ‘God is in the details’ TechnoArchitecture abides by this philosophy. The design approach for the Far Site house’s lies in the idea of simplicity, harmony with the surroundings, authenticity to the materials and connection to detail.”

The 2400 sq.ft. east facing site is located in Malleswaram, which is one of the oldest parts of Bengaluru and is highly prestigious. Over the years, it has developed into a densely populated residential area. Each plot in this set-up has little or no set-backs amongst abutting properties. However, the old street also provides the site with the warmth and shelter of beautiful large trees, here the Indian Beech and Gulmohar trees, amid this concrete jungle.

The initial site conditions contained a house in which the client spent most of his childhood and over many years and with the expansion of the family – it made sense to demolish the old house and allow the new architecture to be subtle yet merge into the old charm which allows the pure forms and spaces to become a backdrop for the family's lifestyle.

The Far Site House is the result of a harmonic set of volumes intertwined with each other that produce a mosaic of light and shadow, transparency, and opacity, where internal and external spaces inter as one environment.

A stilt floor consists of the car park, foyer, a guest bedroom and all other services whereas the ground floor consists of living, dining, kitchen, puja room, master bedroom and sit-outs. The first floor consists of a private master bedroom, kids' bedroom, family area, and private balconies and the partial second floor consists of a multipurpose room that opens into terrace gardens. The house sees a gradual movement from public to semi-public to private spaces from the east facing street side to the west, where the house edge has no set-backs.

While the density of the neighborhood limits the views of the home on the stilt, ground and first floors, the house opens up as one goes higher. The terrace gardens lend an openness that goes beyond the space itself and extends into the surroundings, allowing one to indulge in a 360-degree view of the cityscape. It is this quality that personifies itself as the name of the project, The Far Site House.

At the heart of the Far Site House, is a connection to nature. The signature features like the waterbody, and the landscape bring a sense of ease and tranquility. Almost all areas of the house have visual access to the garden, which provides a pleasing focal point for

a home, enhancing the feeling of being with nature. Each garden in turn opens out to the foliage of the trees in the street. The organization of spaces thus creates a unique take on the traditional courtyard home, extending its terraces outwards, enhancing its effect by accepting the trees as a part of the home itself.

The Far Site House is designed based on five principals:

a) simplicity b) harmony c) authenticity d) connection e) detail

The right mix of materials makes all the difference. Working with warm, earthy, natural materials such as natural clay bricks, clay *jaalis* (perforations), stone floors and wood fenestrations lend great character and personality to the home and get better with time. Not only do they bring warmth to the spaces, but also ensure that the house blends effortlessly with the surrounding landscape. Exposed bricks used extensively develop a unique character over time and require minimum maintenance.

In conjunction with some of TechnoArchitecture's planning strategies of spatial sequencing, framing of views and controlling of light to create a variety of different atmospheres and experiences throughout the house, and also to interweave the planning with contextually important principals of *Vaastu* are at play at the Far Site House. As in many of TechnoArchitecture's buildings, the house is never revealing all at once.

The circulation is planned in such a way that the spaces are slowly unfolded to the visitor in an experimental and spatial journey throughout the house. Twisting staircases through the house in different directions facilitates this non-circular spatial planning. A similar variation is seen in the circulation vertically as well, creating multiple double height spaces.

A cantilevered slab above the terrace garden marks the edge of the home where it meets the sky. Disallowing the wall from meeting the slab above frames the sky as a view one looks up to as well as adds a sense of fun to the façade.

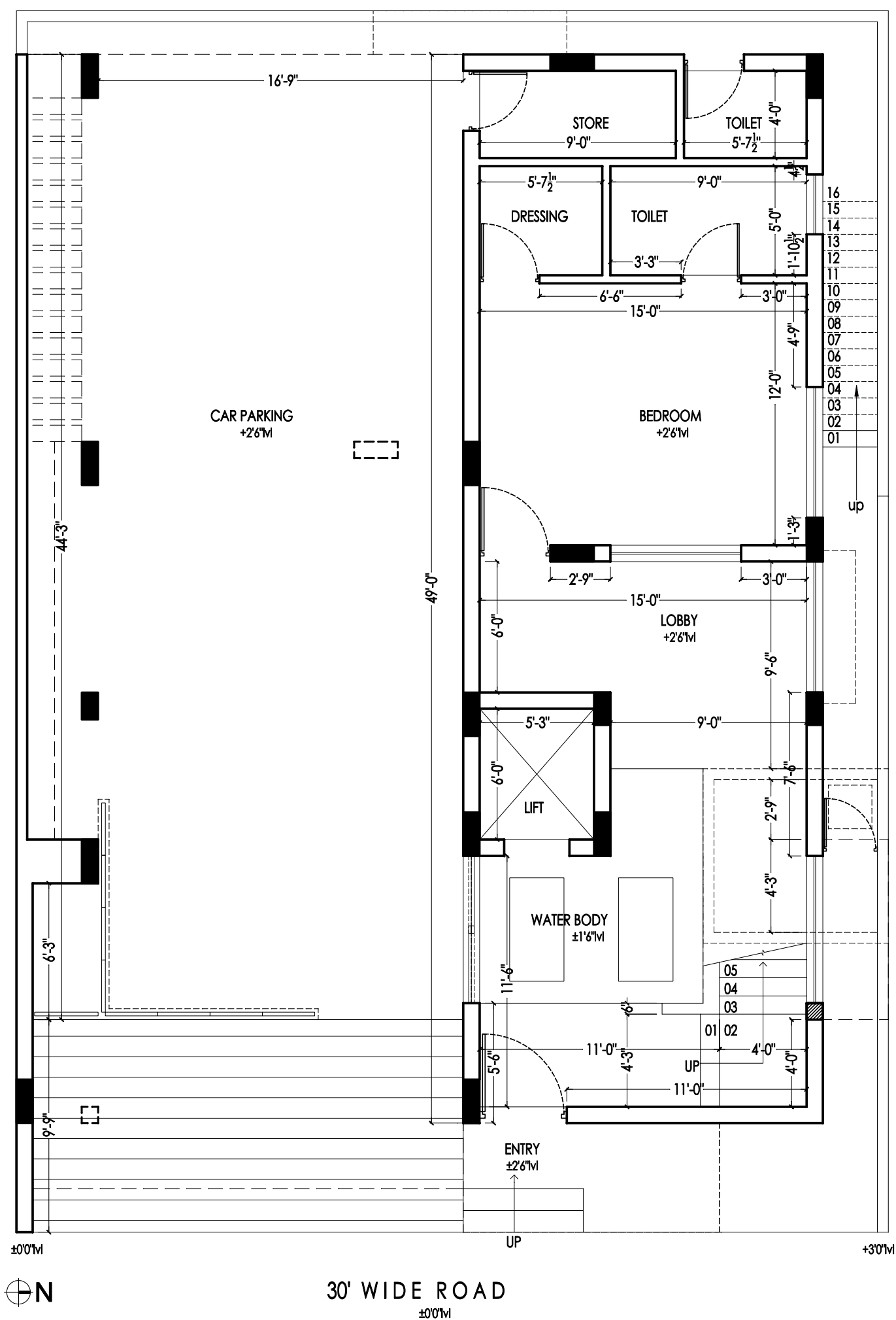
The materials used in the house connect the user with nature providing tropical harmony. The external material palette embraces the antiquity of the region along with *jaalis* create engaging shadow patterns. The interiors endorse the modern demand for comfort.

So, while the brick walls and clay *jaalis* used externally flow into the interiors of the house, the interior color scheme and material palette is kept neutral and just the right amount of quirkiness is added in the furniture and lighting which complement the exposed bricks perfectly.

Natural materials used in the home along with the play of the light and shadow through the different skylights allow the house to live through different measures of time.



Site Plan



Stilt Floor Plan



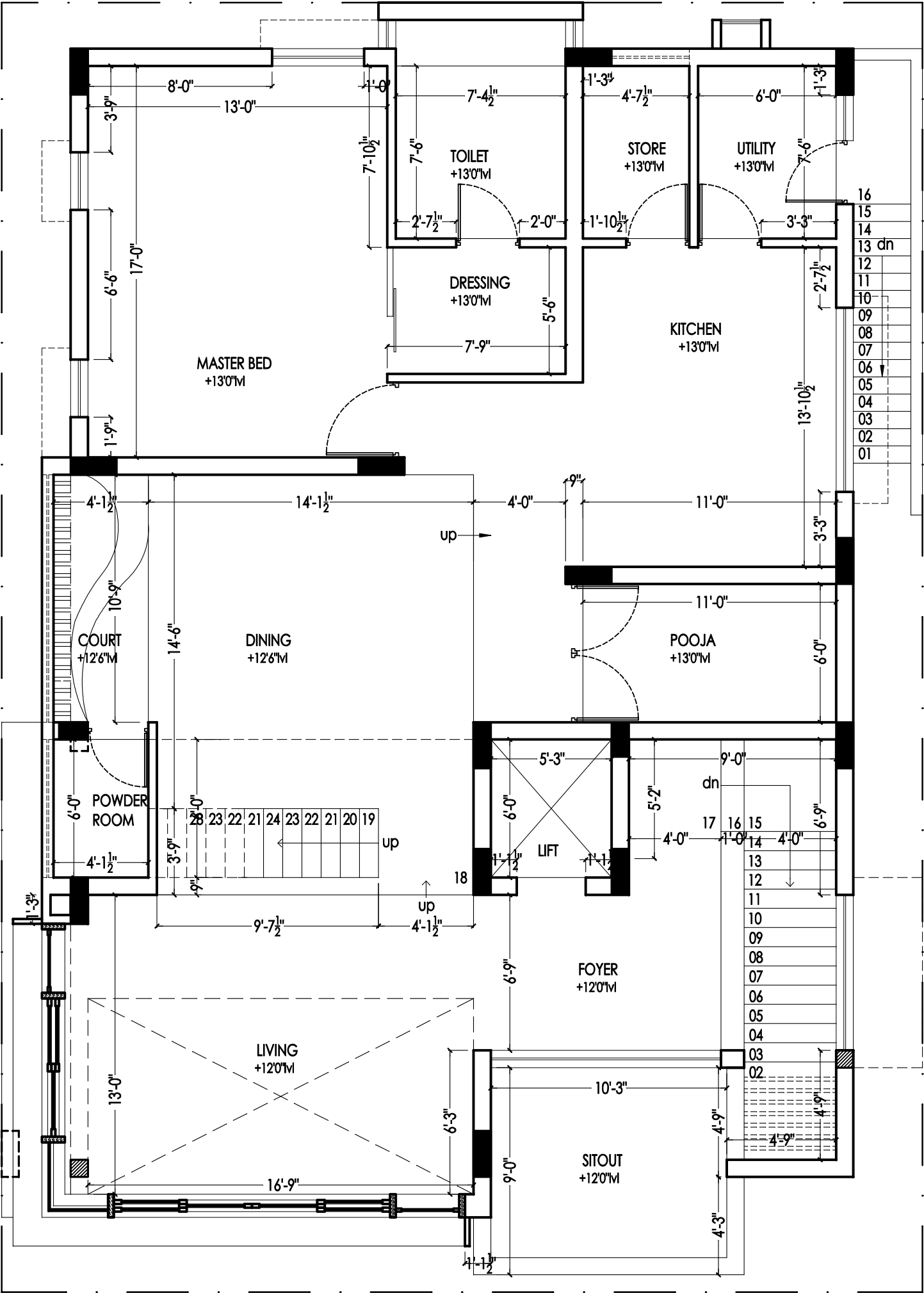
Entrance staircase with the clay *jaali* and exposed brick walls

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Terrace gardens looking into one another under a cantilevered roof slab

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Ground Floor Plan



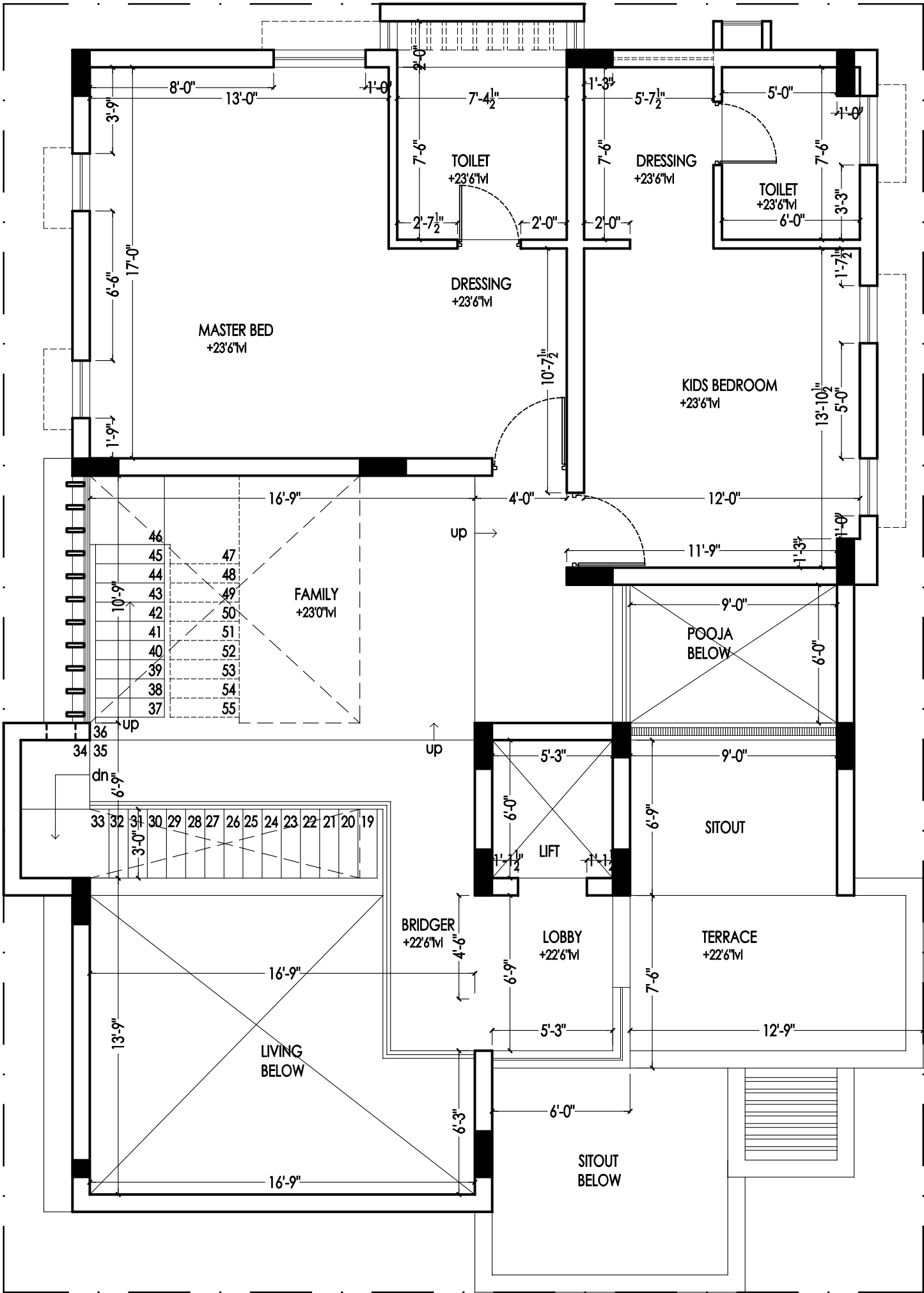
The multilevel terraces moved to the edge of the home, a unique take on the courtyard house

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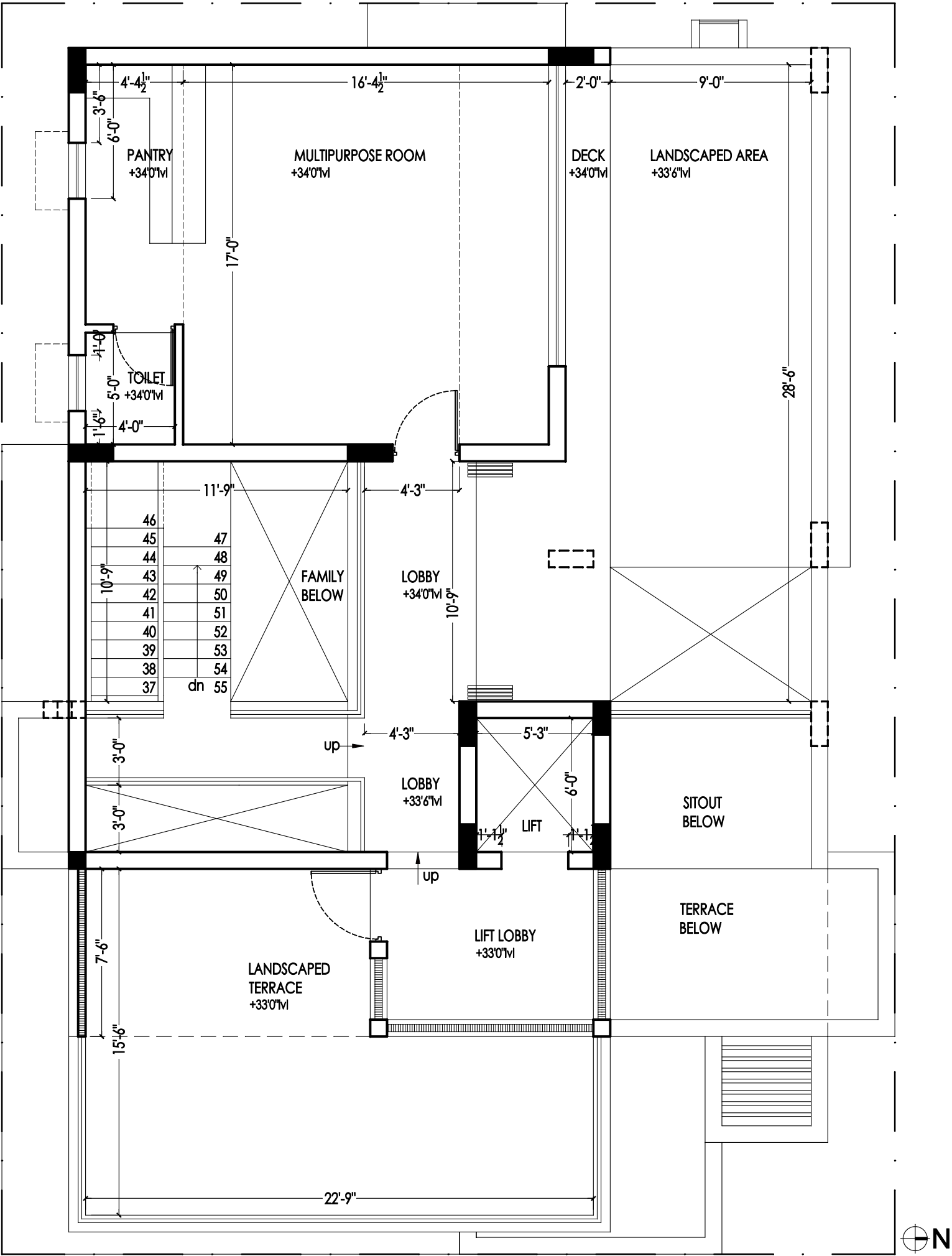


Staircase dividing the living and dining space

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First Floor Plan



Second Floor Plan



LEGEND

1.LOBBY
2.WATERBODY

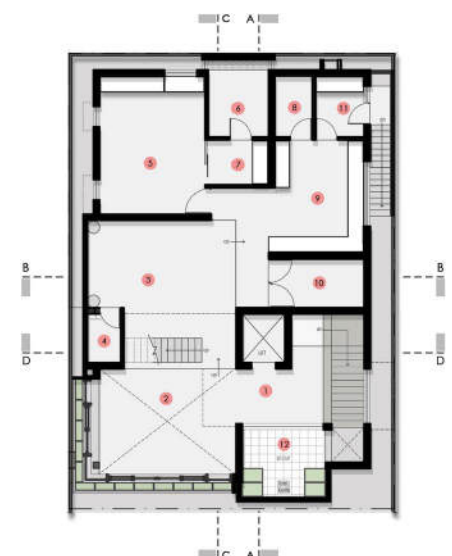
3.TOILET
4.DRESSING

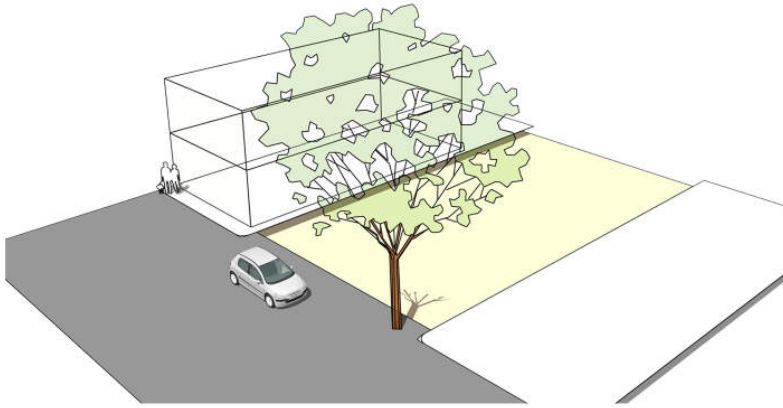
5.DECK
6.MASTER BEDROOM

7.LIFT
8.KITCHEN

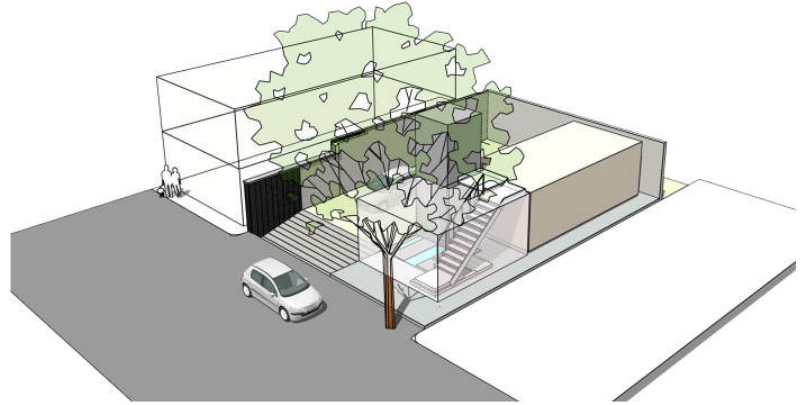
9.SIT OUT
10.FOYER

Section A-A

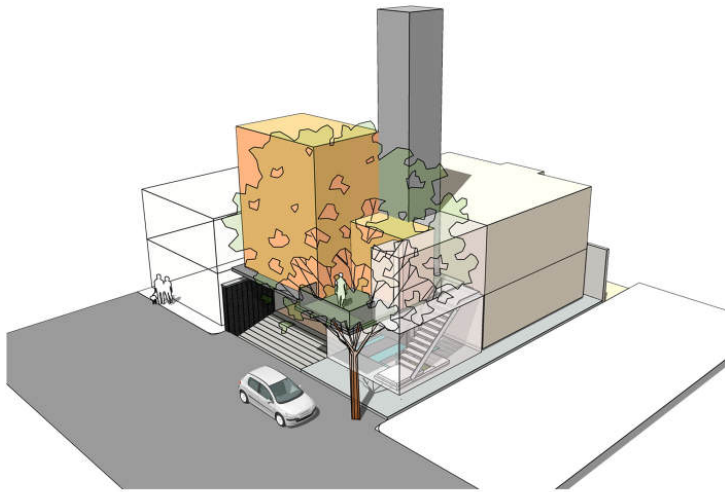




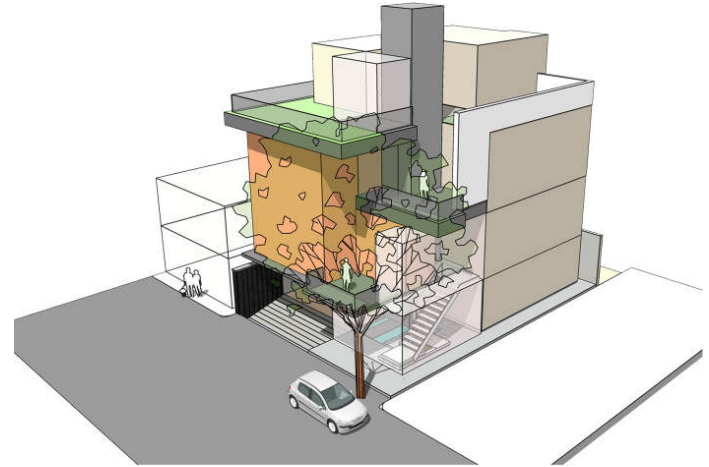
East facing plot of area 2400 sqft.



The Stilt is split into two different zones. One holds the parking area and the other half has the entrance.



The building was built typically vertical keeping in mind the modest plot site and the client requirements.



The rear side of the building was completely abutted by the neighboring property. Hence, it made sense not to have any openings backside.



Balconies and sitouts are positioned strategically over looking the existing tree on the eastern facade.



Introduction of earthy material into the project was of utmost importance keeping in mind the heritage tag of the place.

Massing and Programming



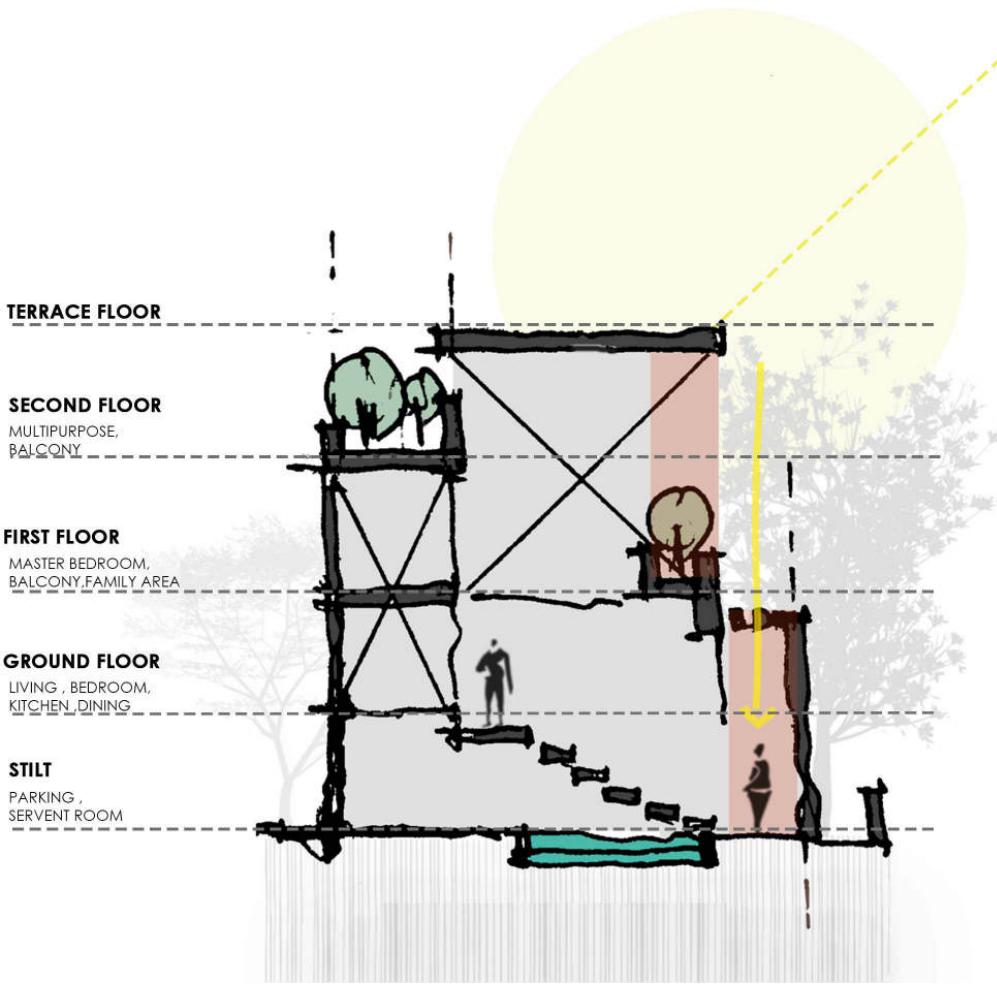
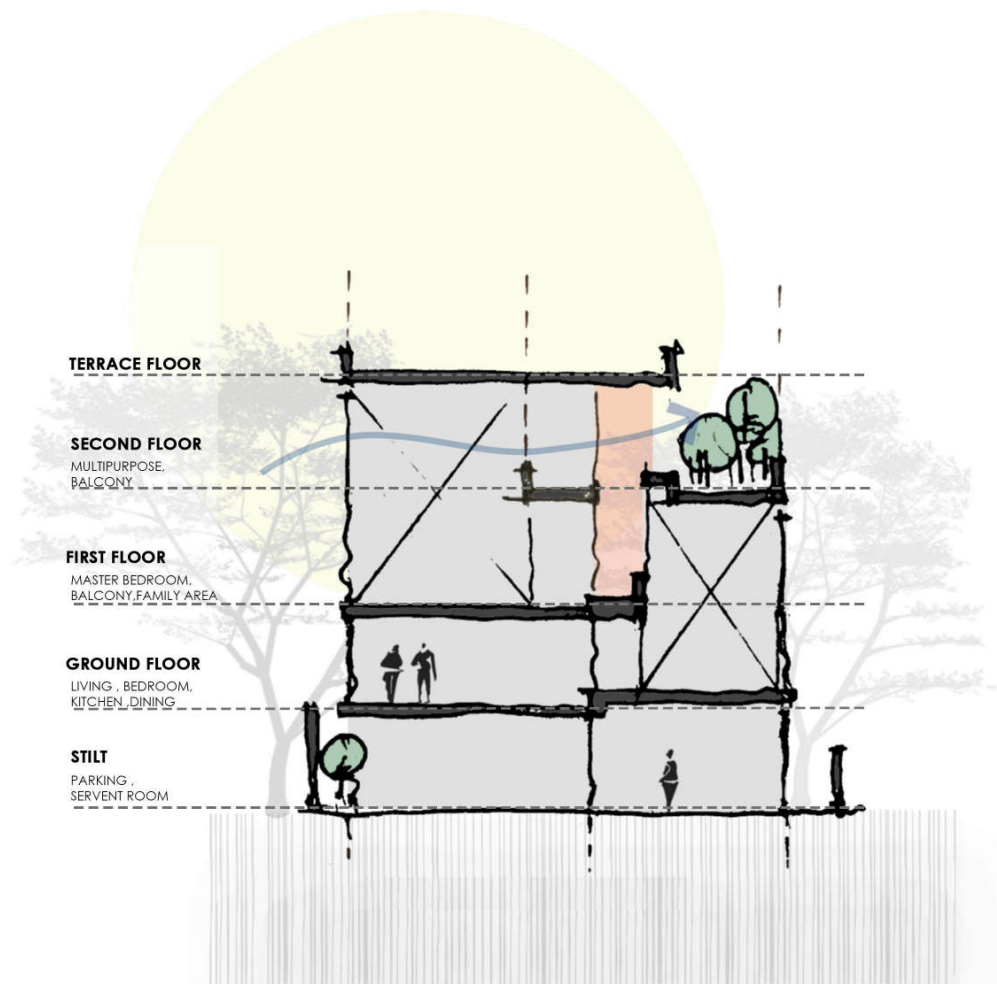
The staircase from the first floor, twisted

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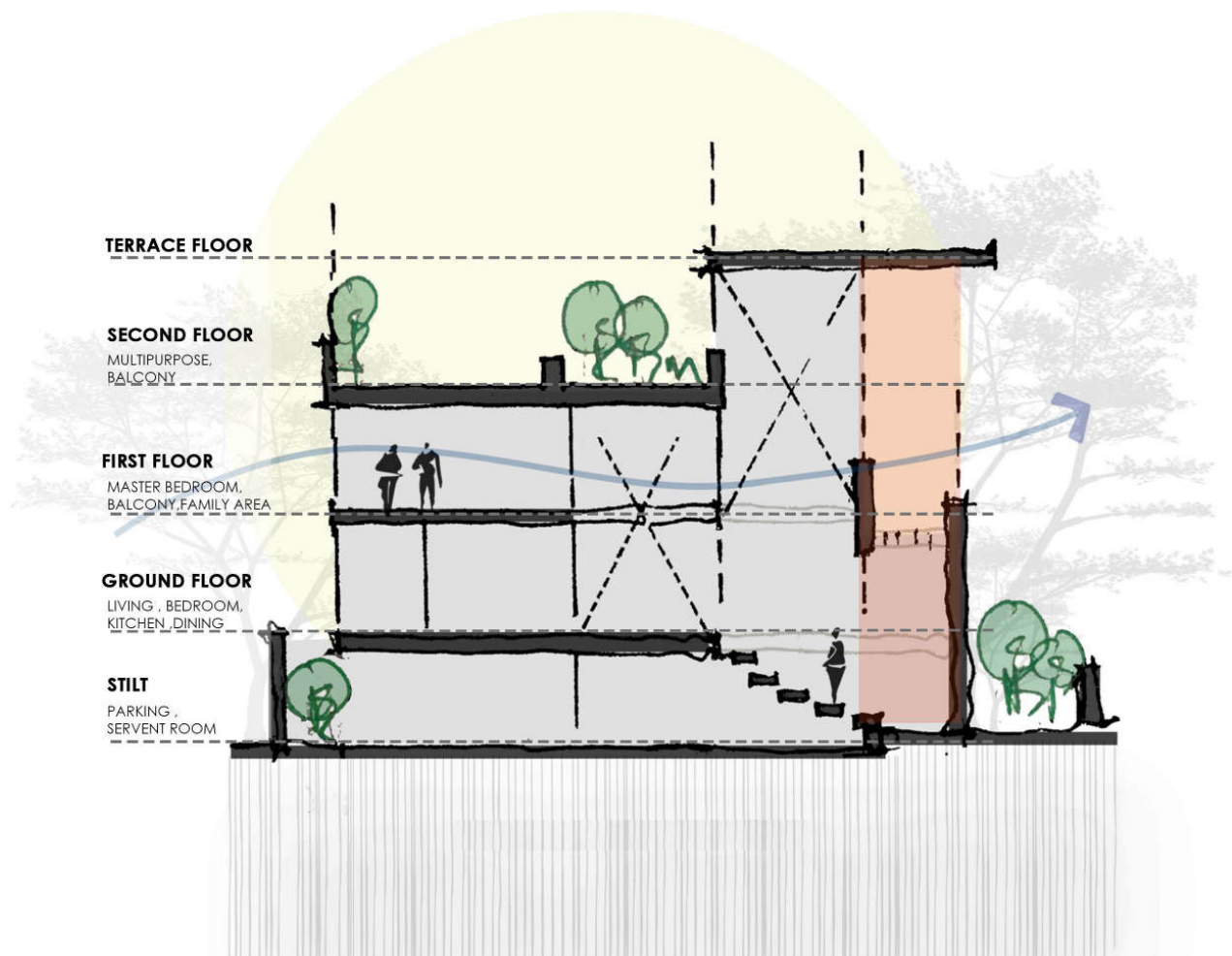
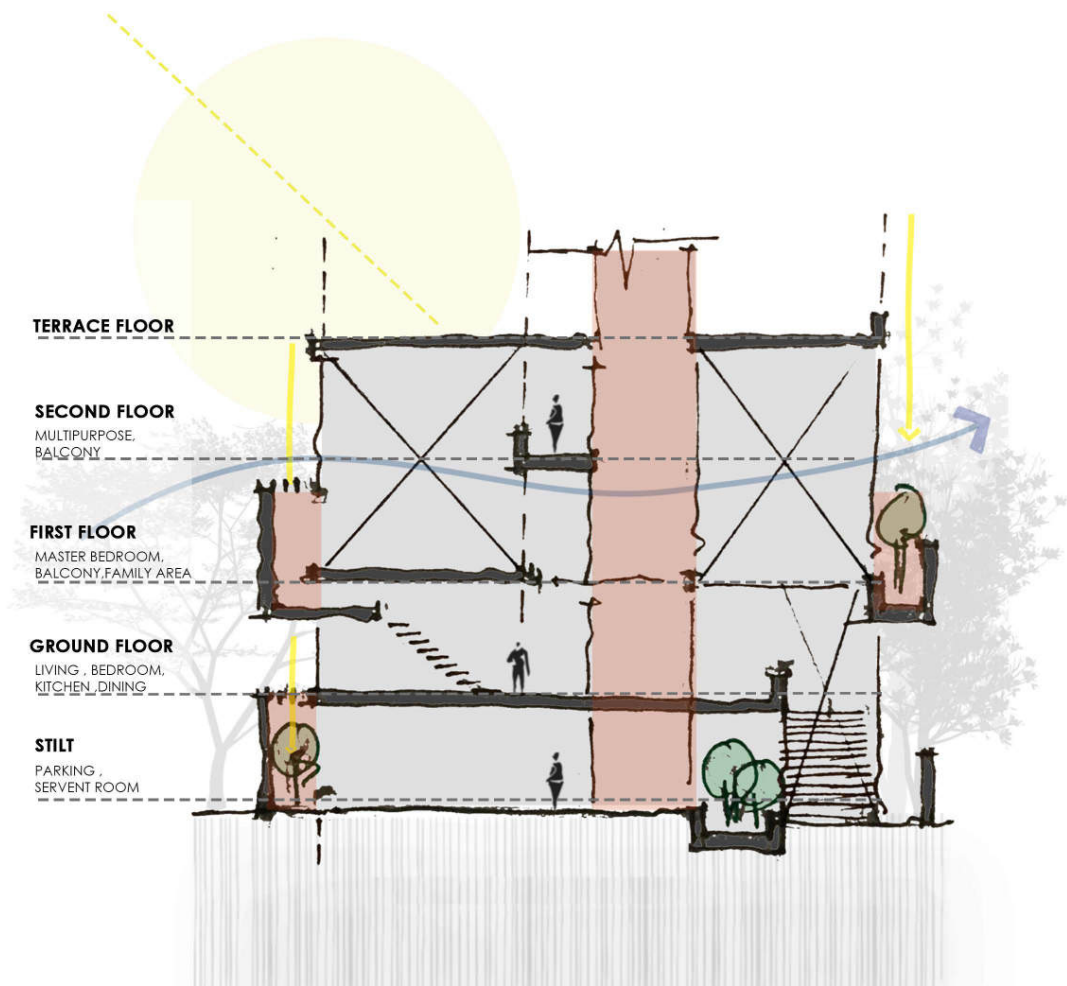


Double-height living and family spaces

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Conceptual Section

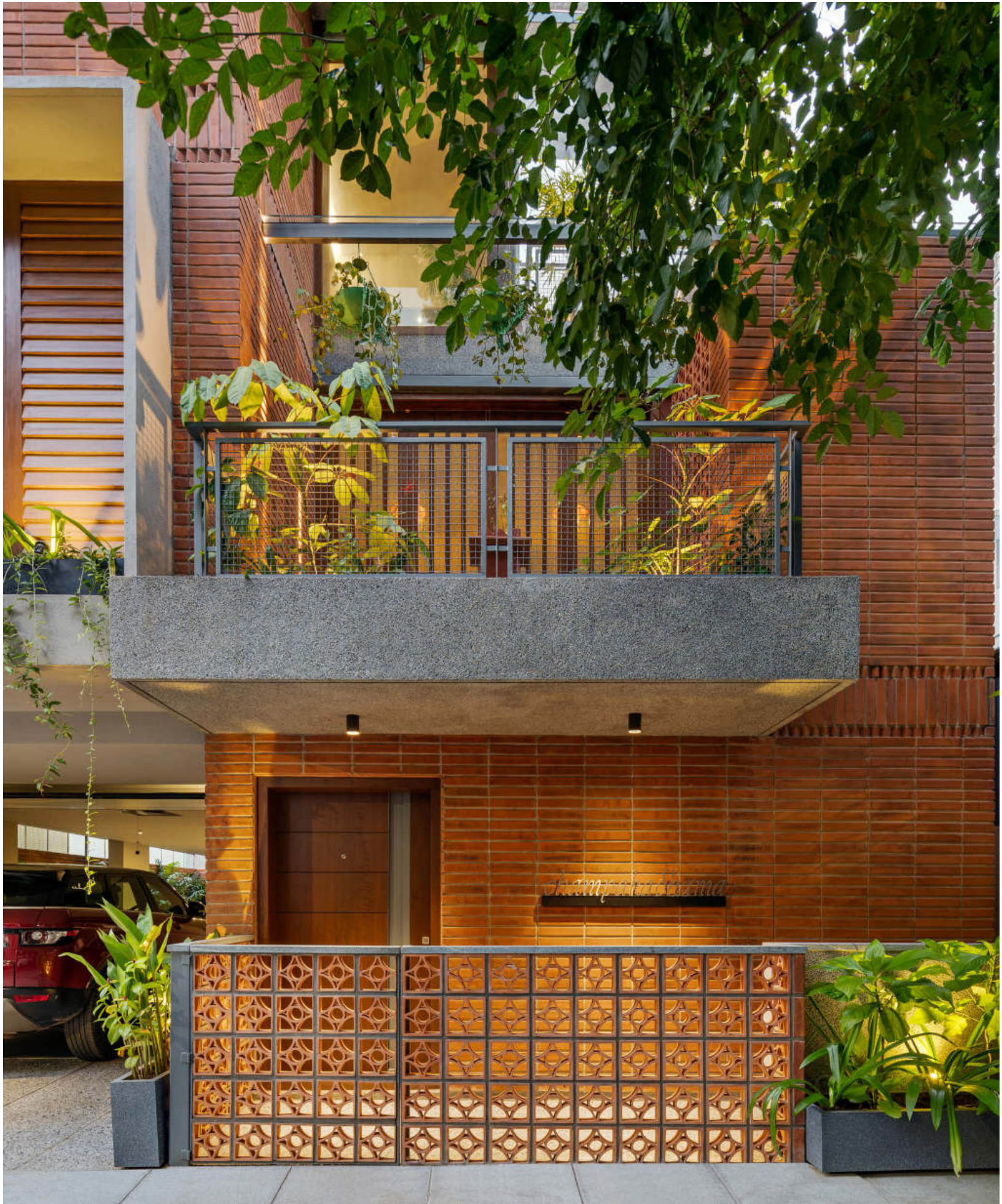


Conceptual Section



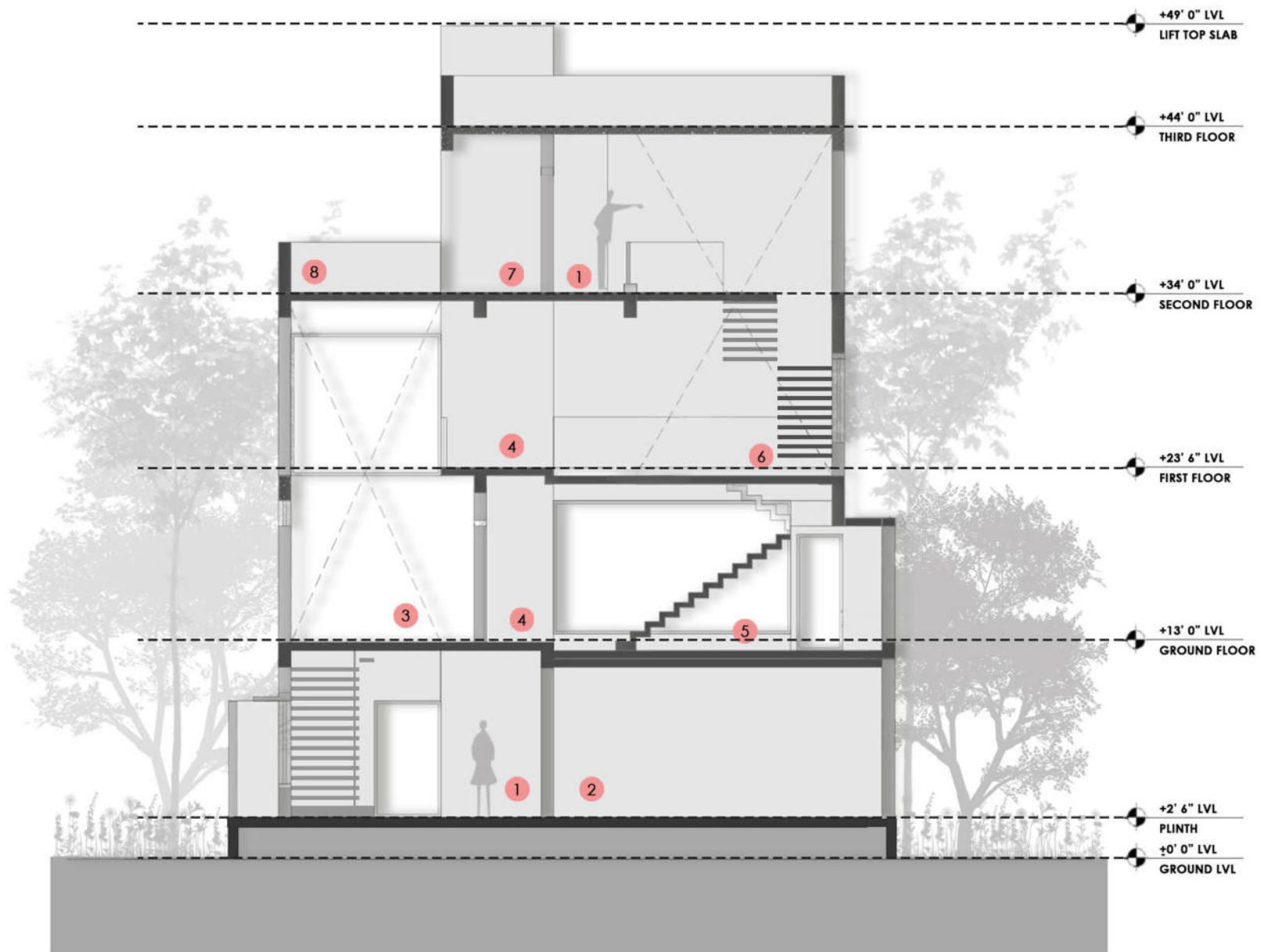
Enclosed balcony amongst open terraces

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Entrance to the Far Site House

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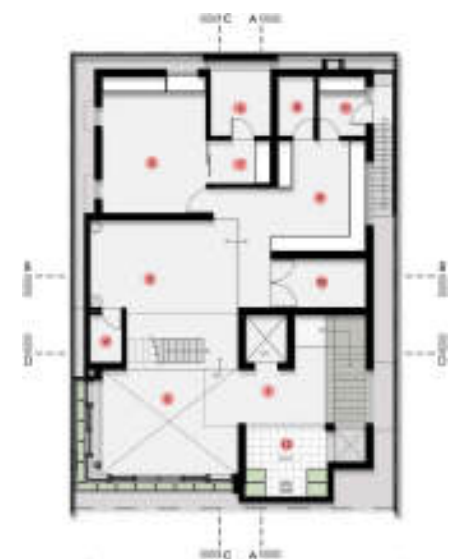


LEGEND

- | | | | |
|----------------|------------|-----------|--------------|
| 1. LOBBY | 3. POOJA | 5. DINING | 7. DECK |
| 2. CAR PARKING | 4. BRIDGER | 6. FAMILY | 8. LANDSCAPE |



Section B-B



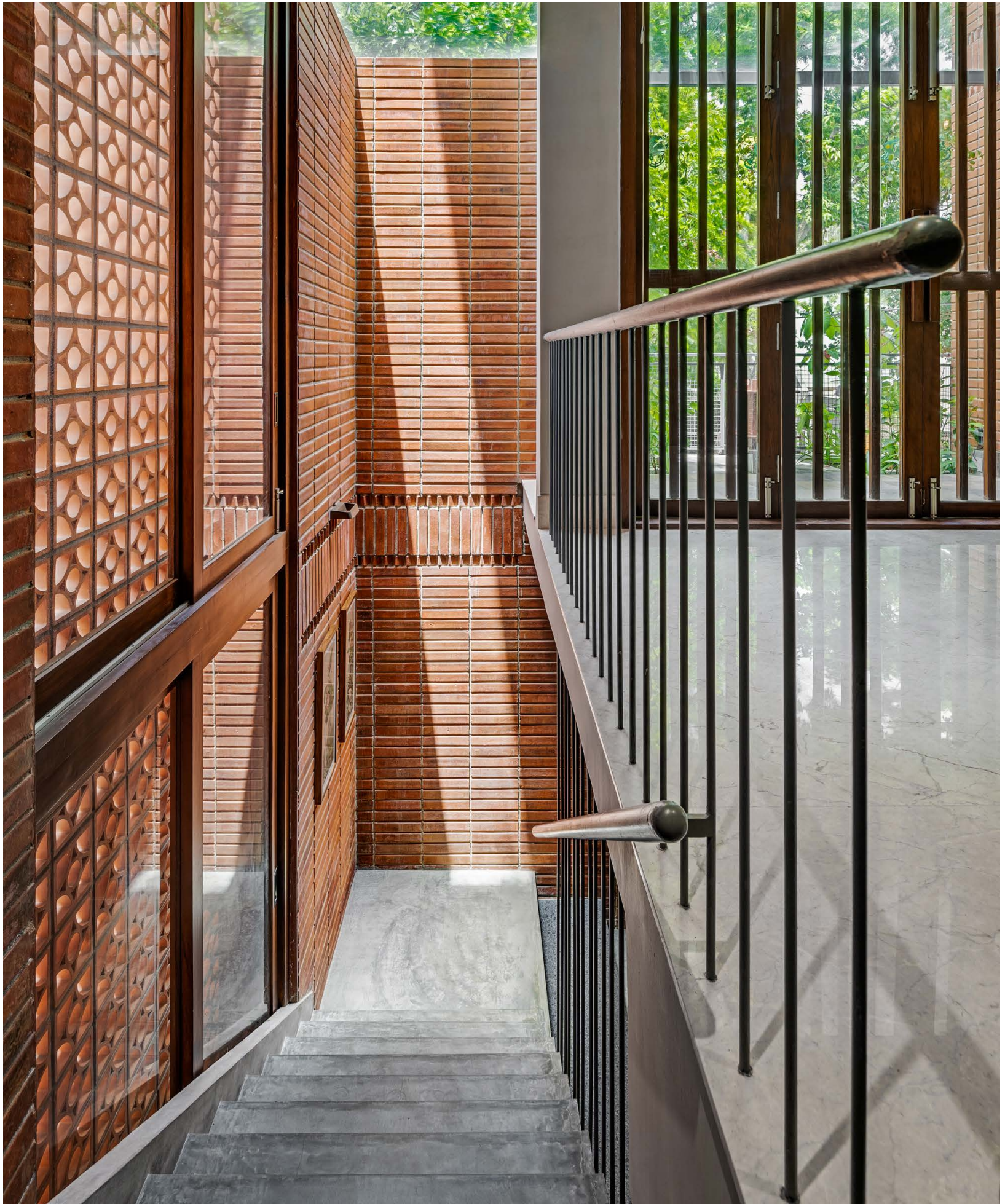


LEGEND

- | | | | | |
|----------------|-------------------|-----------|--------------|----------------------|
| 1. LIVING | 3. DINING | 5. DINING | 7. BRIDGER | 9. MULTIPURPOSE ROOM |
| 2. CAR PARKING | 4. MASTER BEDROOM | 6. FAMILY | 8. LANDSCAPE | 10. TERRACE |

Section C-C





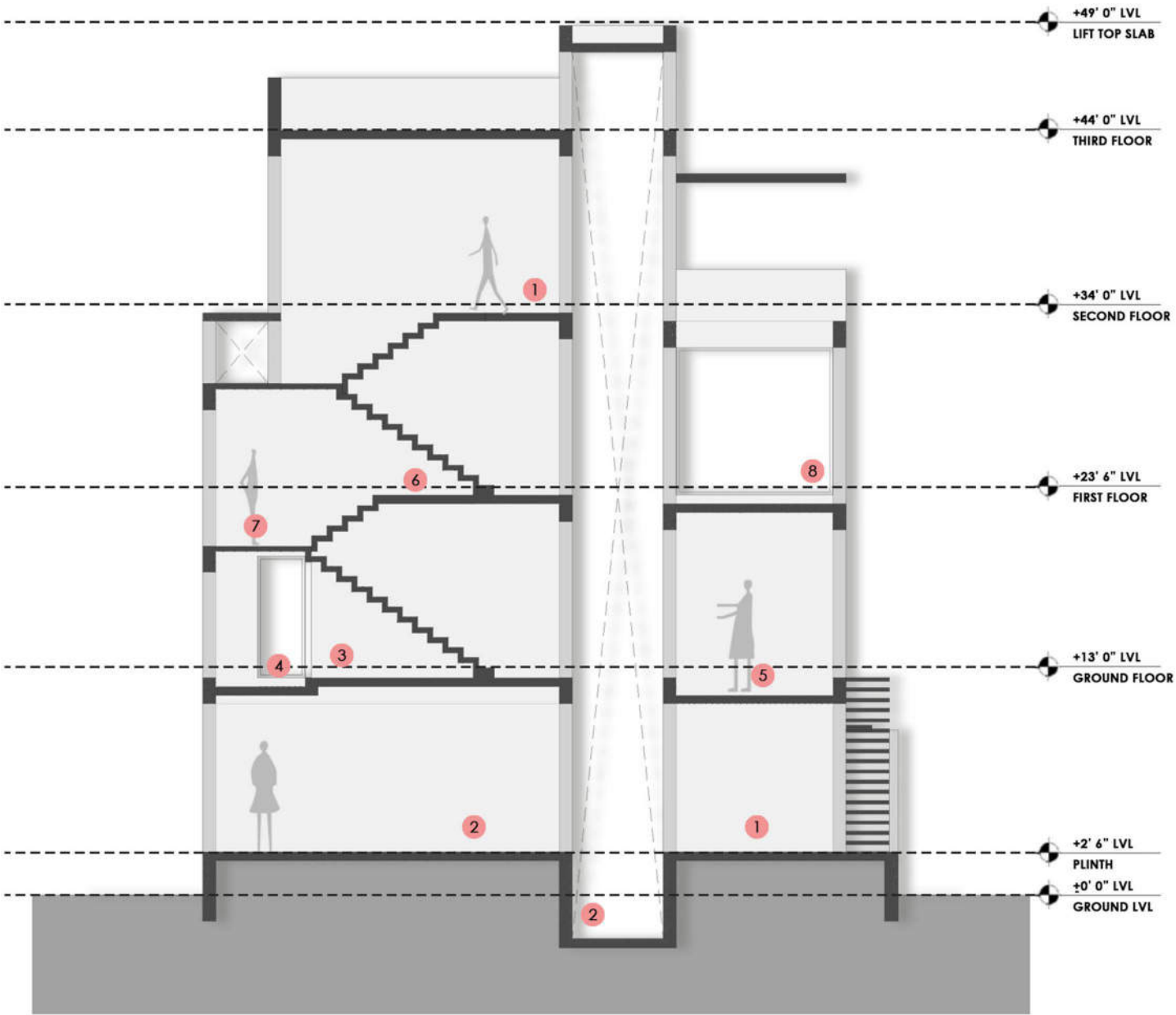
Skylight and perforated *jaali* wall

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Terrace garden with a floating roof slab

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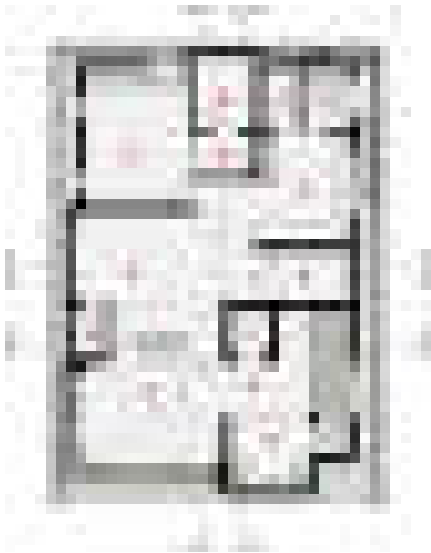


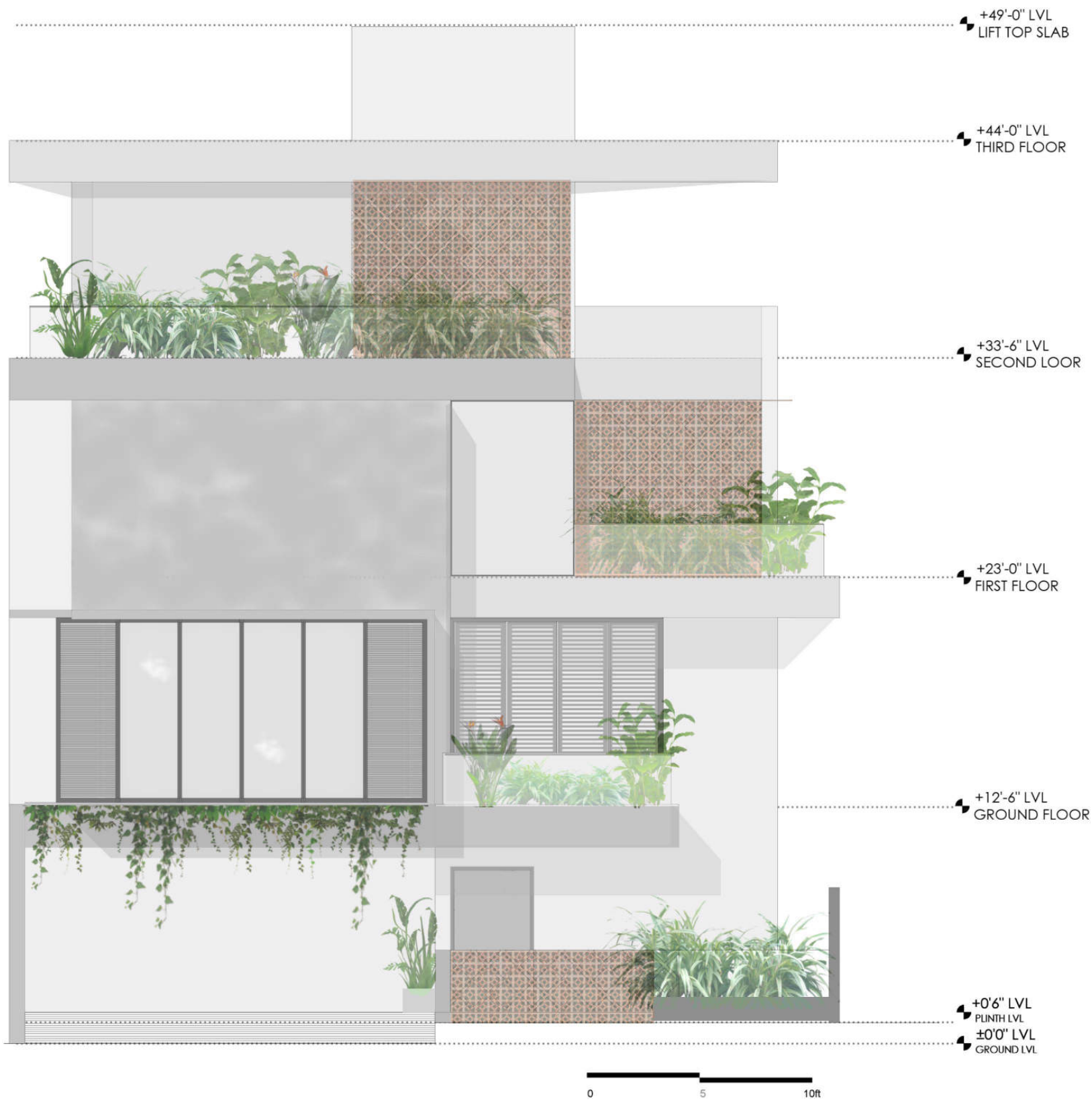
LEGEND

- | | | | |
|---------------|---------------|-------------|----------|
| 1.LOBBY | 3.DINING | 5.STAIRCASE | 7.COURT |
| 2.CAR PARKING | 4.POWDER ROOM | 6.FAMILY | 8.SITOUT |

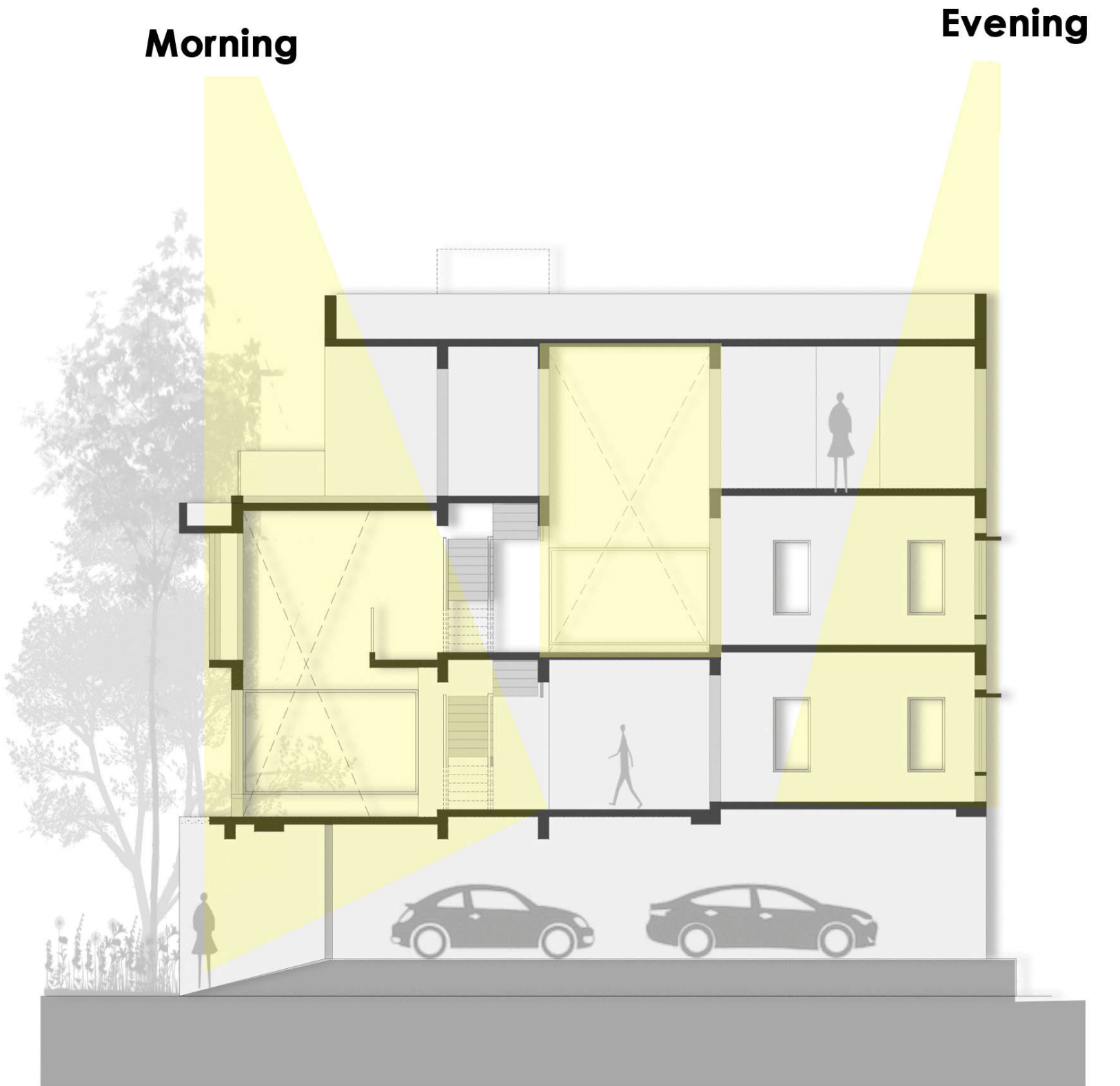


Section D-D





Front Elevation



Section C with Sun-path





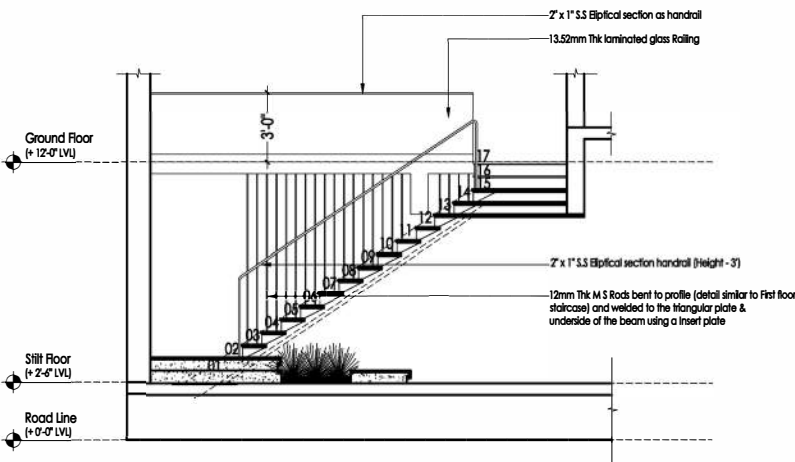
Internal and external green corners



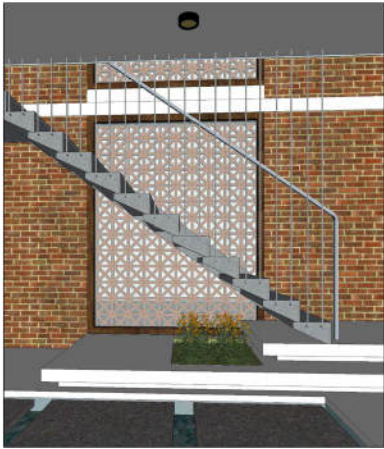


The colours and patterns of the furniture break the monotone of the earthy backdrop of natural materials

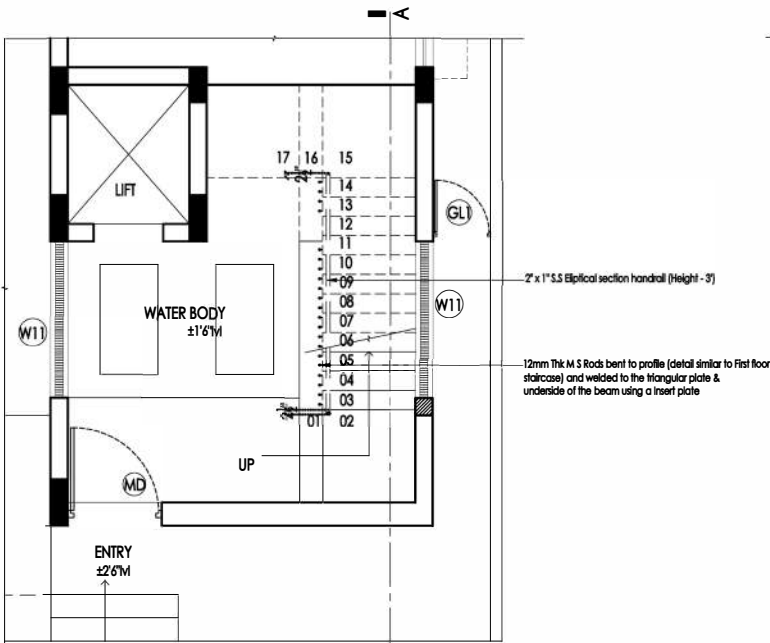
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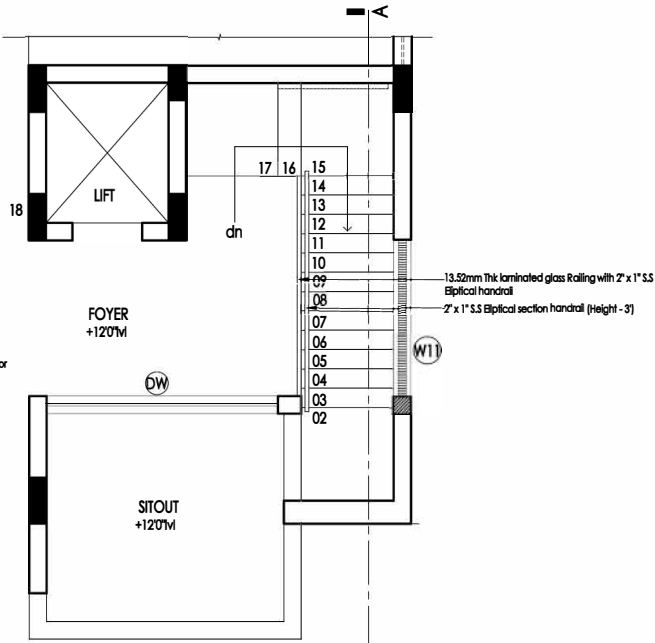
SECTION - AA



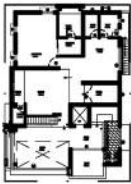
STILT FLOOR STAIRCASE



STILT FLOOR PLAN



GROUND FLOOR PLAN



KEY PLAN - GROUND FLOOR



6mm thick M.S. flats to be welded to every third rod to fix the handrail

DRAWING TITLE :
STAIRCASE AND BRIDGER RAILING - PLANS AND SECTIONS
STILT & GROUND FLOOR

REMARKS:
GOOD FOR CONSTRUCTION

ARCHITECTURE
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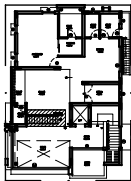
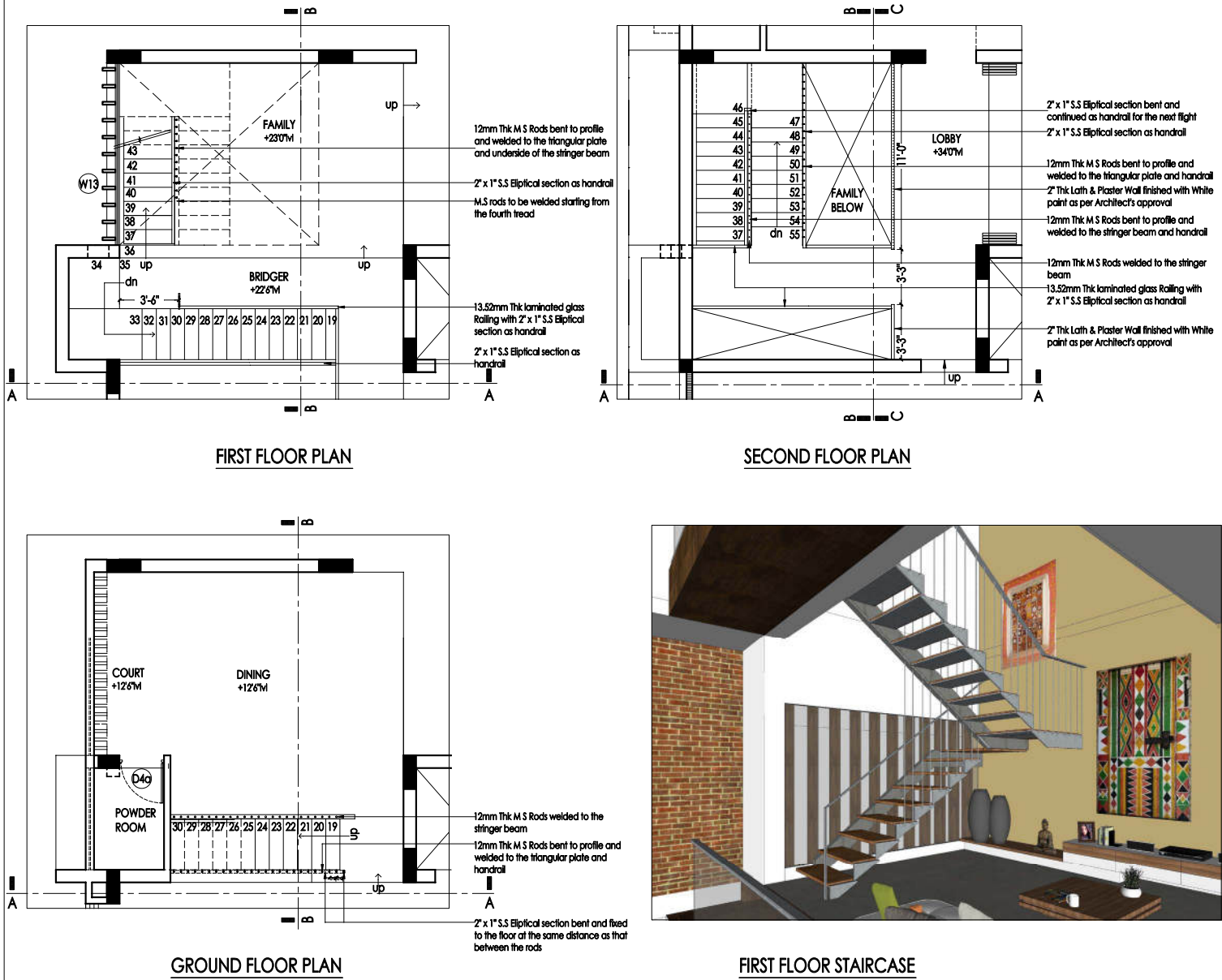
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Dwg no. A3 - 01/05

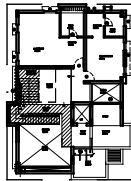
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Bangalore-560 004
Phone 65963992,42103764 technoarchitecture@gmail.com

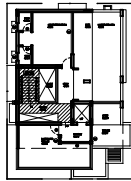
Staircase and Bridger Railing



KEY PLAN - GROUND FLOOR



KEY PLAN - FIRST FLOOR



KEY PLAN - SECOND FLOOR

DRAWING TITLE :
STAIRCASE AND BRIDGER RAILING - PLANS
GROUND, FIRST AND SECOND FLOOR

REMARKS:
GOOD FOR CONSTRUCTION

ARCHITECTURE

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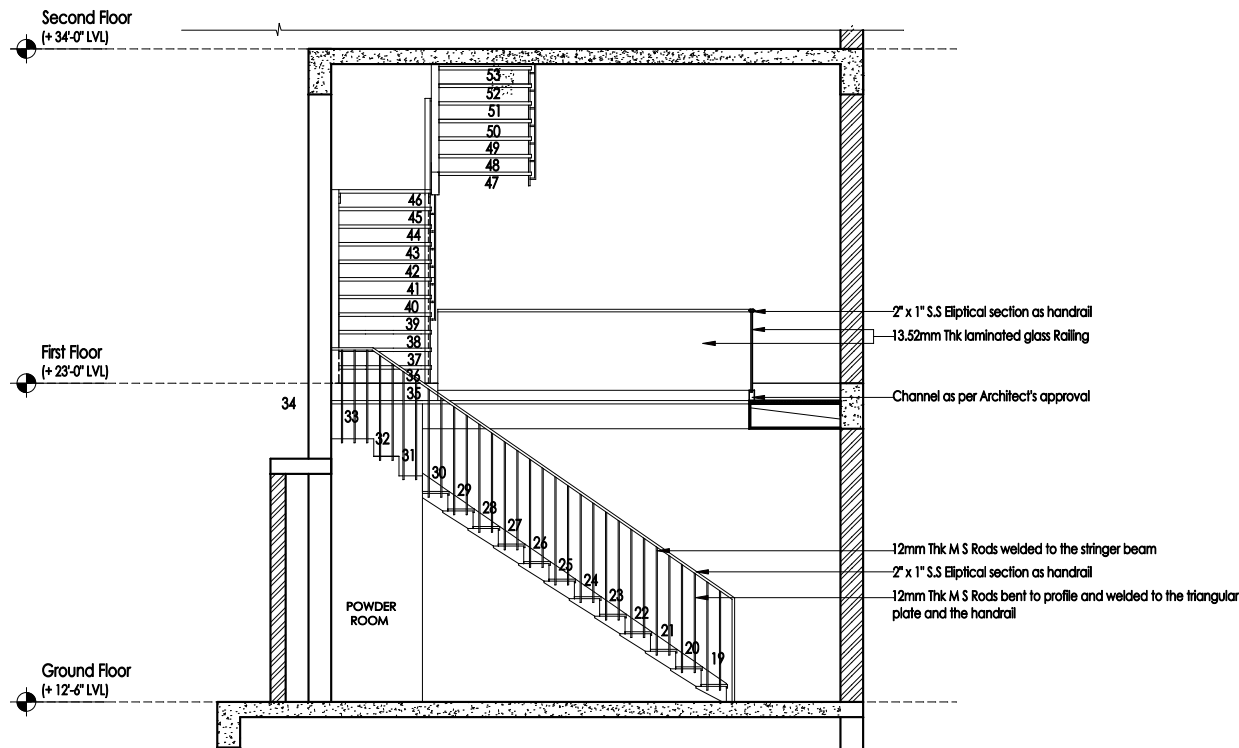
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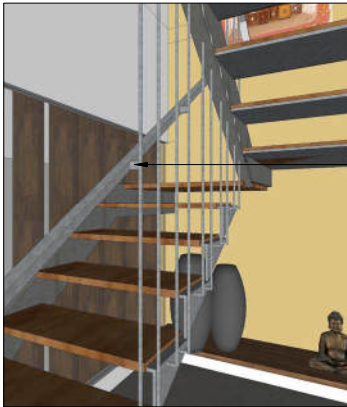
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Staircase and Bridger Railing



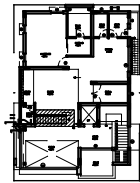
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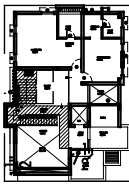
6mm Thk M.S flats welded to every 3rd rod to fix the handrail



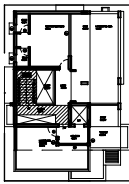
FIRST FLOOR STAIRCASE



KEY PLAN - GROUND FLOOR



KEY PLAN - FIRST FLOOR



KEY PLAN - SECOND FLOOR

DRAWING TITLE :
STAIRCASE AND BRIDGER RAILING - SECTIONS
GROUND, FIRST AND SECOND FLOOR

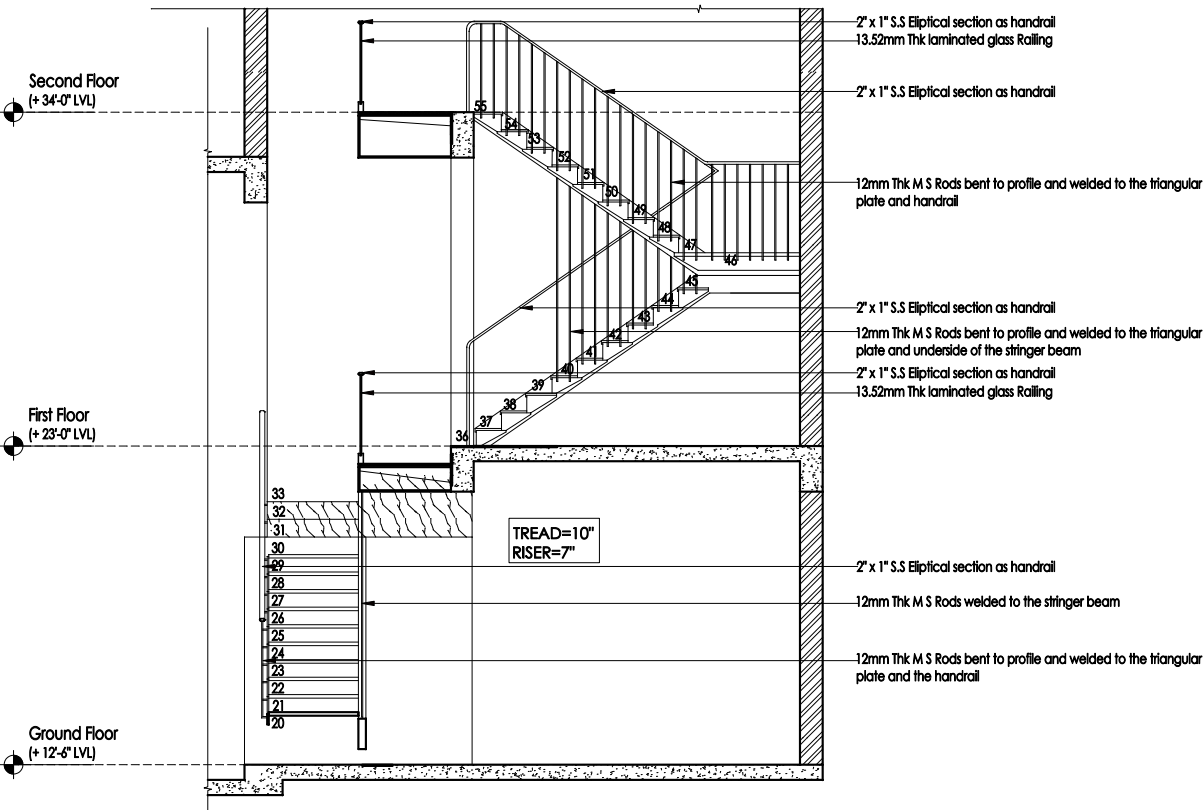
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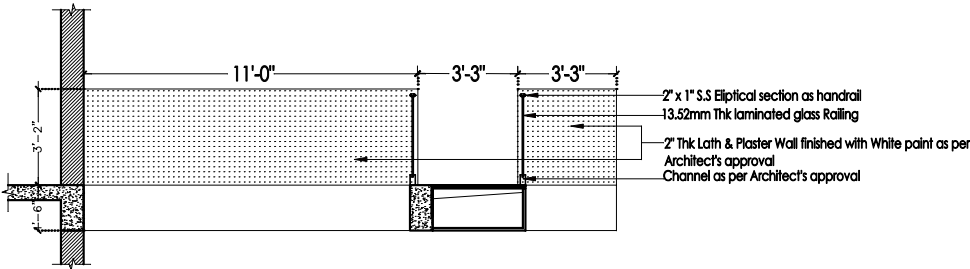
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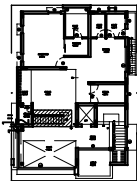
Staircase and Bridger Railing



SECTION - BB



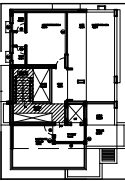
SECTIONAL ELEVATION CC



KEY PLAN - GROUND FLOOR



KEY PLAN - FIRST FLOOR



KEY PLAN - SECOND FLOOR

DRAWING TITLE :
STAIRCASE AND BRIDGER RAILING - SECTIONS
GROUND, FIRST AND SECOND FLOOR

REMARKS:
GOOD FOR CONSTRUCTION

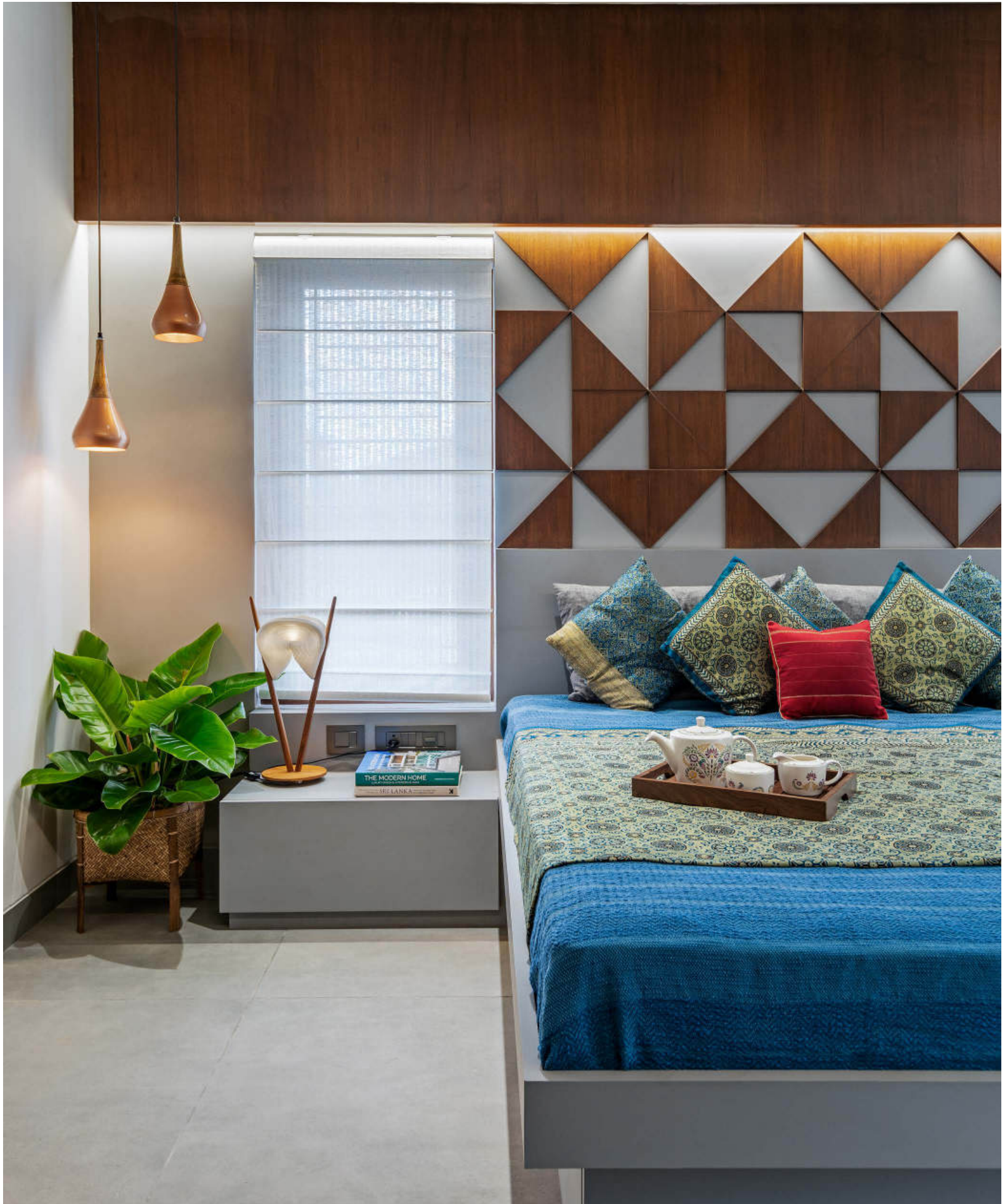
ARCHITECTURE
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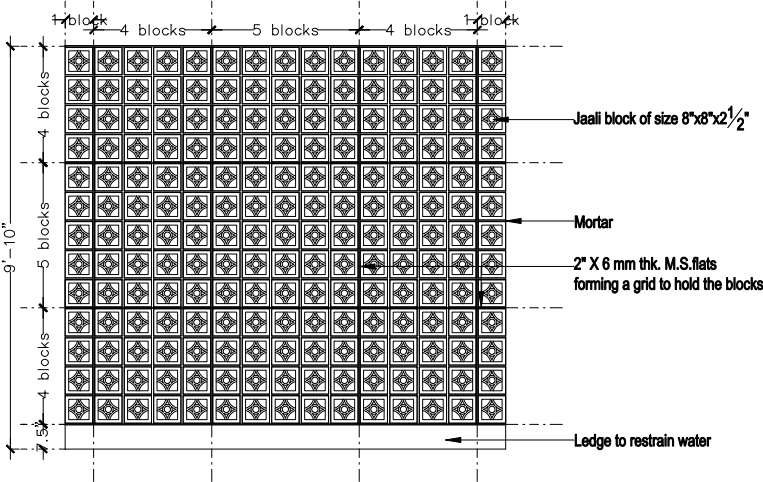
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Staircase and Bridger Railing

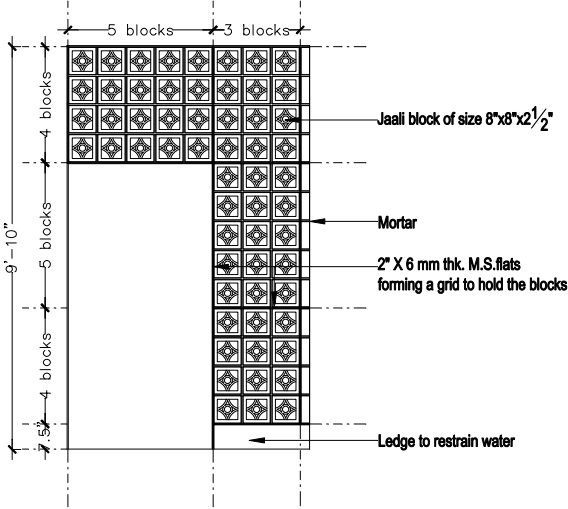


A view of a private bedroom

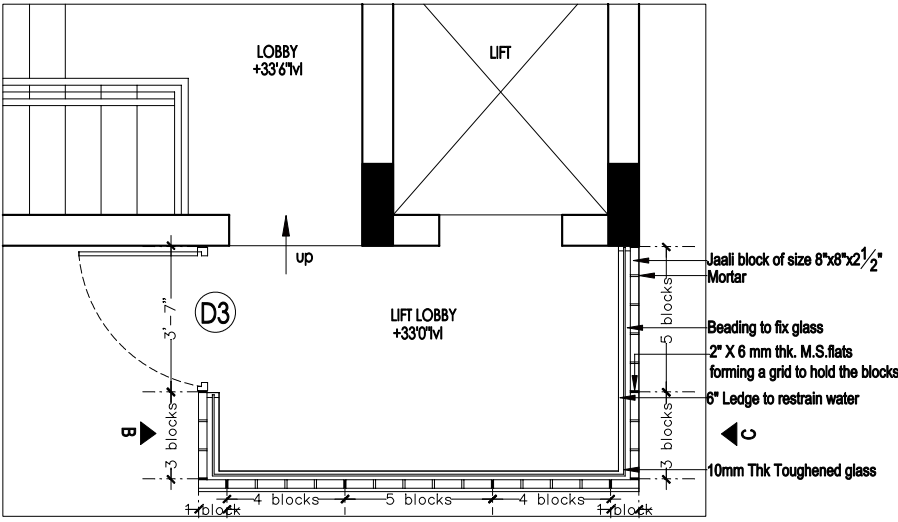
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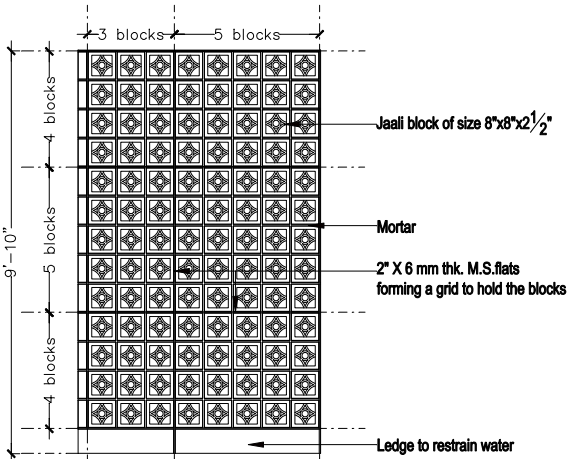
ELEVATION A



ELEVATION B

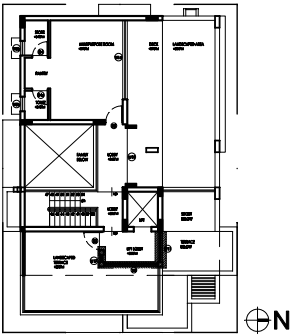


PLAN



ELEVATION C

Note - Dimensions to be cross checked on site and to be adjusted in mortar thickness accordingly



KEY PLAN - SECOND FLOOR

DRAWING TITLE :
TERRACE FLOOR JAALI DETAIL

REMARKS:
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Terrace Floor Jaali Details



Minimal and warm bathroom with a skylight

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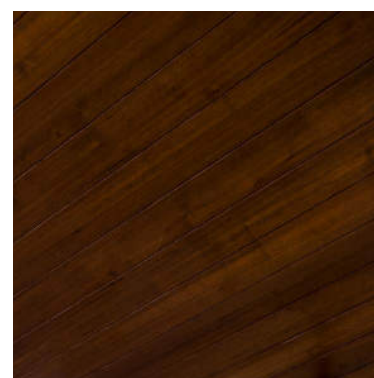
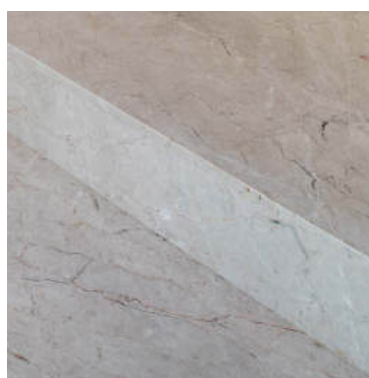
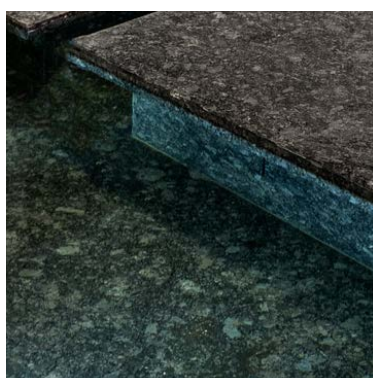
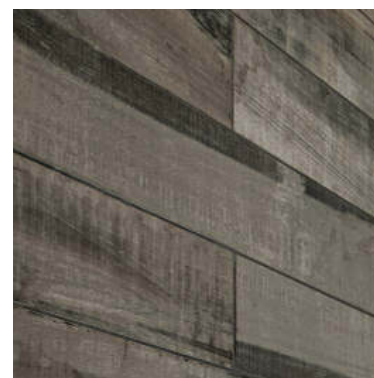
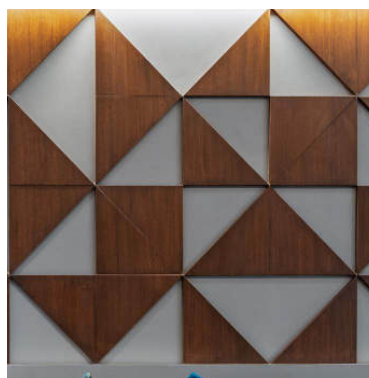
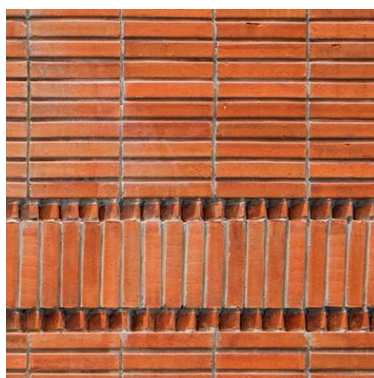


Front facade with the abutting plot

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Interconnected double height volumes



UNIQUE MATERIAL APPLICATIONS

Roofing: R.C.C.

Cladding: Terracotta exposed brick BTW, Kerala

Windows: Teak wood

Tiles: Mirage from Aaren Intpro

Lighting: Amlite

Color: Emulsion from Asian Paints

Sanitaryware: TOTO from Intrend Marketing

Bath Fittings: Grohe

Furniture: Ventura

Furnishing: Fabindia

Carpets & Rugs: Jaipur Rugs

Hardware: Hafele from Hafele India

Modular Kitchen: Arredo3 Kitchen from Ventura

Kitchen Sink: Carysil

Ply: Peelply from Aaren Intpro

Veneer: Timex Veneers

Laminates: Greenlam

Wooden Flooring: Welspun from Intrend Marketing

Security: Eureka Forbes

Air Conditioning: LG

Home Automation: ABB

Marble: Italian marble

Others: Clay *jaali* from Bangalore Tiles

KEY CONTRIBUTORS

Structural/Façade/Landscape/Civil/ MEP:

S.V constructions

HVAC: LG India

Waterbody: Matrix

Landscape: GreenFlash

PHOTO CREDITS

Shamanth Patil